

Facilitator Guide

For facilitators running the build-along on the free tier. No license needed, no data upload — every agent is built from instructions only.

Session at a glance

Tier	Microsoft Copilot Chat (free) — Agent Builder
Session length	60 minutes (45 build, 15 Q&A)
Audience	Knowledge workers across HR, IT, Sales, Finance, CS, Marketing
Group size	Webinar — no participant cap; chat moderation recommended
Format	Webinar build-along — every participant builds their own agent live on the call
Deliverable	Each participant leaves with a working, shareable agent

What this session unlocks

This is the first 'aha' moment for most participants. They've heard about Copilot but never built anything. By the end of the session they have a real, named agent they can share with a colleague the same afternoon — and the muscle memory to make another one tomorrow.

Prerequisites — confirm before the session

- Every participant signed in to copilot.microsoft.com with their work account
- Browser allowed to reach copilot.microsoft.com on the corporate network
- The build-along PDF for their chosen function printed or open on a second screen
- You have personally built each of the six agents at least once — do not run cold
- A backup agent already built in your own tenant in case you need to demo live

Materials checklist

- The six build-along PDFs (HR, IT, Sales, Finance, CS, Marketing) — one per participant
- A short slide (or printed card) listing the six agent names so people can choose
- This facilitator guide open on your podium laptop
- A timer visible to the room (phone or stage clock)

Success criteria

- Every participant has a saved agent in their Agents list before they leave
- At least three participants share their agent with a colleague during the session
- Participants can name one concrete first task they will give the agent on Monday
- Energy in the room stays high — sessions die when people get stuck silently

Agenda & Timing

Block-by-block plan. Run the clock visibly — participants build faster when they can see the pace.

Time	Block	Talk track / Action
00:00 - 05:00	Open & frame	Frame the 'four tiers of Copilot' picture. Today is tier 1 — free, no data, no admin.
05:00 - 10:00	Pick your agent	Each participant picks one of six functions. Two minutes max — decisiveness sets pace.
10:00 - 25:00	Build steps 1-3	Create agent, paste instructions, add suggested prompts. Walk the room.
25:00 - 35:00	Test live	Use the 'Try These Live' page. Two prompts each, then share a result with a neighbour.
35:00 - 45:00	Share & extend	Click Share. Each participant sends their agent link to one colleague.
45:00 - 55:00	Q&A and 'where next'	Answer questions, point at the paid tier as the next session.
55:00 - 60:00	Close	Restate the four-tier story and the homework: use the agent twice this week.

Pacing tip

If the audience is mixed-pace, drop a stretch task into chat for the fastest builders ('add a fourth starter prompt that tests a boundary the instructions set') instead of pushing the slower builders to catch up. People learn at different speeds — protect the call.

Facilitator Notes — Step by Step

What to say, what to do, and what to watch for at each build step.

1 Create the agent

Say: We're going to build a real, working agent in the next ten minutes. No code, no upload.

Do: Share your screen and walk through Agents panel → Create agent. Ask for thumbs-up reactions when each person lands on the screen.

Watch for: Some tenants put Agents under a sub-menu. Pre-check the path on your tenant.

2 Paste agent instructions

Say: The instructions are the brain of the agent — tone, rules, what to refuse.

Do: Have everyone paste the block from their PDF. Read one line aloud so they spot the pattern.

Watch for: Copy-paste from PDF can drop blank lines. Tell them blank lines matter for readability.

3 Add suggested prompts

Say: These are one-click examples — they set expectations for new users in 5 seconds.

Do: Add three pills from the PDF. Encourage one personalised pill of their own.

Watch for: Suggested prompts have a length limit — keep them short and active.

Facilitator Notes — Continued

Final build steps, common blockers, and how to keep the room engaged.

4 Save and try live

Say: Click Create — your agent is now in your Agents list, shareable, real.

Do: Have everyone try the first 'Try These Live' prompt and share what they got.

Watch for: First responses can feel generic. **Coach:** tighten the instructions, retry.

5 Share with a colleague

Say: This is the moment Copilot stops being abstract — you've shipped something.

Do: Each participant clicks Share, sends the agent link to one colleague over Teams.

Watch for: Some will be shy. Tell them 'pick the one person who'd benefit most' — done.

Engagement prompts (use when energy drops)

- Who has tried something the agent refused to do? What did it say? (refuses build trust)
- Who got a response they want to share? Drop the funniest one in the chat.
- Who's already thought of an agent they want to build that wasn't in the six PDFs?
- If you could share this with one person back at your desk, who would it be — and why?

Common Blockers & Q&A Bank

The questions you will be asked. Have these crisp.

Common blockers (and your fix)

- **Participant can't see Create agent in their Copilot Chat**

→ Confirm they're signed in with their work account, not a personal one. Personal accounts have a different UI.

- **Agent ignores the instructions and gives a generic answer**

→ Tighten the rules to a numbered list ('1. Use only this data 2. Refuse anything else'). Tone alone is too soft.

- **Suggested prompts won't save**

→ Each prompt has a character limit. Shorten to under 80 characters and retry.

- **Can't share — Share button greyed out**

→ Some tenants restrict external sharing; share inside the tenant only. Confirm with the admin team if they ask why.

Top participant questions

Q: Does the agent use my company data?

A: On the free tier, no. It uses only its training data and the instructions you wrote. To use your company's docs, mail, or files, you need a paid M365 Copilot license — that's the next session.

Q: Is anyone else seeing my agent?

A: Only people you share it with. The agent is private until you click Share.

Q: What happens to the conversations people have with my agent?

A: Conversation handling follows your tenant's Copilot policies. There's no separate 'agent log' you have to manage.

Q: Can I delete or update it later?

A: Yes — open the agent in your Agents list, edit, save. Anyone you shared with sees the new version on the next prompt.

Q: Why would I use this instead of just chatting with Copilot directly?

A: Two reasons: consistent persona across many people, and one-click starter prompts that train newcomers in seconds.

Tier Comparison & Per-Function Reference

Use this to answer 'why this tier, not another?' and to tailor language by function.

When to use which Copilot tier

Tier	Best for	Time to value	Governance
Free Copilot Chat	Pure-instruction agents anyone can build, no data upload	5 minutes	Tenant policies apply; no extra data residency to consider
Paid M365 Copilot	Add your own knowledge (Excel, docs) for grounded answers	15 minutes	Stays inside the tenant; admin governs sharing
Copilot Studio	Full agents with topics, tools, orchestration, evaluations, channels	Hours to days	Solution-managed; DLP, RLS, Entra auth, audit trail
Copilot Cowork	Task-driven recurring work using your live M365 surfaces	10 minutes	Acts as the signed-in user; consent and review-before-send patterns

Per-function quick reference

HR — Onboarding Buddy

FOCUS

30/60/90 day planning and 1:1 prep for new joiners.

WATCH FOR

Don't invent benefits — redirect to HR portal.

IT — Self-Help Coach

FOCUS

Plain-language fixes for VPN, MFA, Outlook, password.

WATCH FOR

Two failed attempts → escalate with summary.

Sales — Discovery Coach

FOCUS

Discovery questions, openers, objection rehearsal.

WATCH FOR

No invented facts about the prospect's company.

Finance — Expense Helper

FOCUS

Right-first-time expense submissions; categories, FX, mileage.

WATCH FOR

Never quote policy numbers — point at the policy URL.

CS — Response Drafter

FOCUS

Three tonal variants per customer reply: pro / warm / short.

WATCH FOR

Calm de-escalation for abusive messages — don't match tone.

Marketing — Idea Brainstormer

FOCUS

Safe / Stretch / Bold campaign concepts per brief.

WATCH FOR

No statistics, quotes, or competitor claims invented.

Closing

Five minutes to build. One colleague to share with. That's the whole story.

Closing talk track

Frame this as the first of four sessions. Free Chat was today; tomorrow they can add their own data with paid M365 Copilot; later they'll build full Studio agents and Cowork tasks.

Homework: use the agent twice this week. Once for real work, once to break it.

Invite them to bring questions to the next session — the questions are where the real learning happens.